> If we put the Israeli Police there—even if they are Arab policemen, and there will have to be Arab policemen there—we can be sure that there will be no Fedayeen operations.
>
> *My proposal is that we be there on the ground, but without annexation.* I am sure that there is no possibility, even if we were not facing increased (Jewish) immigration, for us to absorb 300,000 more Arabs. There is no way for this small and miserable country to take in another 300,000 Arabs.

From there, Ben-Gurion moved on to the events taking place in the Soviet bloc, such as the revolt in Hungary and the immigration of Jews from Poland to Israel. He then predicted: "It is not impossible that there will also be an immigration from Russia. I'm not saying that it will be today or tomorrow. It depends on political developments in the Soviet bloc, perhaps also in China. . . . But we must not rule out the possibility that in the coming years we will face an influx of immigrants from Russia, and if there is a wave of immigration from there, it will be the final redemption of the State of Israel. We must reach four million Jews in the State of Israel. This can be provided by Russian Jewry."

He then returned to the refugee issue:

> In the current reality, we do not have the ability to absorb 300,000 Arabs. The annexation of Gaza would make us responsible for 200,000 refugees and another 100,000 residents. Among the latter there are many who have no income. I think what we should strive towards, and it does not depend on us, but I think that it is possible, is not to let the Egyptians back there. There is a legal basis for this; it cannot be claimed that this is a sovereign territory—they [the Egyptians] invaded it. The world has accepted that the armistice agreement is no longer relevant—even Hammarskjöld says this when he has to make claims against us. This has been accepted. *Egypt has no hold in Gaza.*

In response to a question from one of the ministers, Ben-Gurion stressed that this was not about occupation and annexation but about governing de facto, without committing to a specific period of time. He added:

> What will be with the refugees at the end of the day? I believe we must take a stance. In any case, when I am asked what will happen to the refugees in Gaza, I say that they are part of the refugee problem in general, and that we must find a solution for all the refugees. This solution cannot be found in Israel. The solution can be found only in Iraq and Syria, but it is clear to me that this solution will not happen without peace. As long as there is no peace, Iraq and Syria will not agree to settle the refugees because they are holding the refugees as a political weapon against us. A temporary governing regime can last thirty years or even fifty years. I do not believe that there will not be peace for another thirty years or fifty years, though it is impossible to know.

In response to another question, Ben-Gurion said: